CENTRAL BANK OF THE UNITED ARAB EMIRATES

Notice on Consumer Protection in Digital Banking and Open Finance

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Date: 30 October 2026

[Illustrative test document for the RegWatch live demo; not an official publication.]

To: All Licensed Financial Institutions

1. Scope

1.1 This Notice applies to all licensed financial institutions that provide digital banking or open finance services to consumers in the UAE.

2. Complaints

2.1 Licensed financial institutions shall acknowledge every consumer complaint within two working days of receipt.

2.2 Licensed financial institutions shall resolve complaints within 15 working days and inform the consumer of the outcome in writing.

2.3 Licensed financial institutions shall not charge any fee for submitting a complaint.

3. Automated decisions

3.1 Licensed financial institutions shall inform consumers when a decision that materially affects them is made solely by an AI model, and shall give them the right to request a human review of that decision.

4. Open finance consent

4.1 Licensed financial institutions shall obtain explicit consumer consent before sharing account data with an open finance participant; consent shall not exceed 12 months.

4.2 Consumers shall be able to revoke consent at any time.

5. Security

5.1 Licensed financial institutions shall apply strong customer authentication with two factors to payment initiation.

5.2 Licensed financial institutions shall report material cyber incidents affecting open finance APIs to the Central Bank within 24 hours.

6. Implementation

6.1 Licensed financial institutions shall comply with this Notice by 1 March 2027.